

lation. There's a way to do this without a registry hack, but using the following hack is simpler. First, just move the required folders to the new locations. Then...

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\User Shell Folders

Open this Registry key and edit the full path for each special folder with the corresponding new path. For example, the default location of the My Documents folder is "C:\Documents and Settings\username\My Documents. Move the folder to, say, "F:\Documents", and update the value for the "Personal" setting with the new path, that is, "F:\My Documents", without the quotes.

The change should take effect immediately.

Change The Location Of The Windows Installation Files

If you installed XP from a CD and then copied the installation discs to your hard disk, use this hack to change the default installation folder that XP will look for when it searches for additional setup files later.

Navigate to:

HLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Setup

Change the String Value called SourcePath to one specifying the path to where the XP setup files are now stored. When you next need to access any setup files, XP will first look in this new location, instead of you having to click "browse" and browsing to there.

Disable The Search Assistant

The new search assistant is an annoyance to many people. Not only does it have a weird number of counter-intuitive search options, it also connects to the Microsoft site without the user's permission,